PassFrame
TUITION

The Stranger at the Anchor Inn

Year 5 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction

Extract — read it carefully before answering

The stranger arrived at the Anchor Inn on a wild October evening, when the wind howled like a wolf around the chimney pots and rain lashed the windows in grey sheets. He was a broad man with a scarred cheek and a sea-chest so heavy it took two stable boys to carry it indoors.

'A room,' he growled to my father, dropping a handful of coins onto the counter, 'and quiet. I want no visitors, no questions, and no talk of ships.'

From that first night, strange habits followed him. Every morning he walked alone along the cliff path with a brass spyglass tucked under his arm, scanning the grey horizon as though he expected, at any moment, to see a sail appear. Every evening he sat by the fire with a mug of rum, singing fragments of an old sea-shanty under his breath, and his eyes — pale as winter sky — would dart to the door at the smallest sound.

I was only a boy then, but I noticed things grown-ups often missed. I noticed how his hand trembled, just slightly, whenever a sailor passed through the village. I noticed the long, puckered scar that ran from his ear to his collar, and the way he flinched if anyone asked about it. Most of all, I noticed that he never once, in all his weeks at the inn, told anyone his real name.

It was my mother who first called him Captain, though nobody had given him the title. Somehow, it simply fitted — and somehow, we all understood, without quite knowing why, that danger had followed him through our door.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. On what kind of evening did the stranger arrive at the Anchor Inn?

2. What three instructions did the stranger give the narrator's father?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you the stranger watched the sea every morning.

4. Underline 2 similes in the extract.

5. What does “trembled” suggest about the stranger's hand?

6. True or false: the stranger told everyone his real name.

7. Why do you think the stranger “wanted no visitors, no questions, and no talk of ships”?

8. What physical mark on the stranger made the narrator curious?

9. In your own words, explain why the villagers began calling him “Captain”.

10. What does the phrase “danger had followed him through our door” suggest about the stranger's past?

11. Why do you think the narrator, as a child, “noticed things grown-ups often missed”?

12. What do you predict might happen later in the story because of the stranger's arrival? Use evidence to support your idea.